



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Do you know how to write a résumé?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe issues relating to money, in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What does a résumé look like?
- What are some good things to have on your résumé?

Can Do Statements

- I can exchange complex information about my work.
- I can explain how to write a résumé.
- I can talk about facts and courses of actions.





Let's Explore!

Kristi gives Adam some **pointers*** on writing a résumé.

* "A *pointer*" is a bit of advice or a tip.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Adam: Kristi, thanks for agreeing to help me with my résumé. What I really need is to focus on writing an effective one.

Kristi: Absolutely. What I really liked about the workshop is that the tips were really on point.

Adam: For example?

Kristi: What a résumé should do is help you land an interview. Once you get that, it will, hopefully, land you the job.

Adam: I get it. What you said in the e-mail made sense. My résumé is too general.

Kristi: Right. The first thing we need to work on is the layout. What you want to present is a clearly organized summary of your qualifications.

Adam: What a friend had told me is that a résumé gets scanned for 25 seconds.

Kristi: And if your résumé is hard to read and poorly organized, you won't even get an interview.

Adam: So, formatting, uh?

Kristi: To begin, use a logical format and wide margins. Do use clean type and clear headings.

Adam: Ok. I get it.

Kristi: Then, you need to use bold and italic on areas that you want to catch the reader's eye. It is also important to use bullets to emphasize accomplishments.

Adam: What you are saying is that I should identify accomplishments rather than just job descriptions. Right?

Kristi: Yes! Include a one line job description and your list of accomplishments.

Adam: And how do I go about doing that?

Kristi: Use action verbs. Instead of saying you worked with customers, you could say you "cemented relationships with customers".

Adam: I like the sound of that.

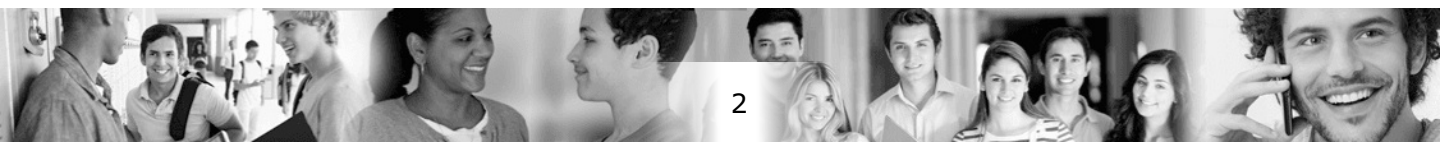
Kristi: It says here you "helped employees". You could rewrite this as you "empowered employees through shared decisions".

Adam: Those are great.

Kristi: And don't write that you 'dealt with problems'... say "I solved problems without increasing costs."

Adam: Thanks, Kristi. You've been a great help. Let's grab a coffee.

Kristi: Your treat?





Let's Practice!

Kristi knows a lot about writing resumes!

Instructions: Select all the correct answers.

1. Which sentences have long subjects?
 - a. What I really need is to focus on writing an effective one.
 - b. What I really liked about the workshop is that the tips were really on point.
 - c. What a résumé should do is help you land an interview.
 - d. Once you get that, it will, hopefully, land you the job.
 - e. What you said on the e-mail made sense.
 - f. My résumé is too general.
 - g. What you want to present is a clearly organized summary of your qualifications.
 - h. I like the sound of that.



Let's Practice!

Kristi explains what to do.

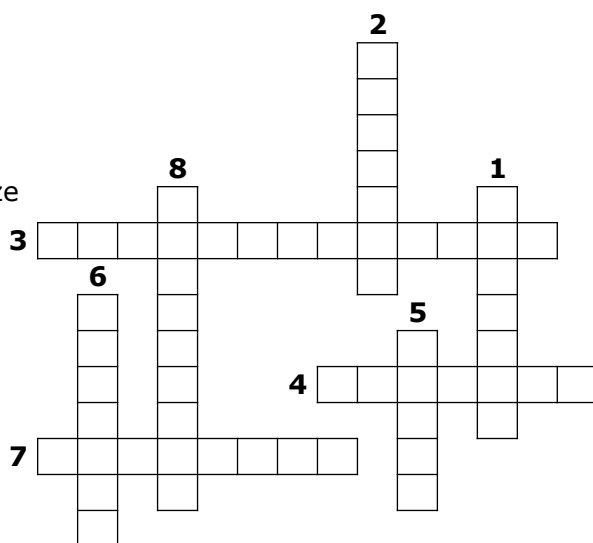
Instructions: Read the conversation on page 2. Read the clues to complete the crossword.

Down

1. The tips were really o____t.
2. You want to present a clearly organized s____y of your qualifications.
5. You want to c____h the reader's eye.
6. It is also important to use b____s to emphasize accomplishments.
8. You e____d employees through shared decisions.

Across

3. Use a logical f____t and wide m____s.
4. A résumé gets s____d for 25 seconds.
7. You could say you c____d relationships with customers.





Extension Activity

Talk about and plan a résumé.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Reread the dialogue.
- Tell a friend about 3 or 4 things you need to include on a résumé.
- Tell your friend about your past academic or work related accomplishments.
- Write out a rough plan in bullet points of the information you would like to include in your own résumé.
- Discuss the plan with a friend.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I explain how to write a résumé.

☐ ☐

I exchange complex information about my work.

☐ ☐

I write about complex information about my work.

☐ ☐

I share my information with someone.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- on point** (expression): spot on or exactly right
e.g. What I really liked about the workshop is that the tips were really on point.
- summary** (noun): a short account giving only the most important information on something
e.g. We want to present a summary of your qualifications.
- to scan** (verb): to read something very quickly in order to get the general idea
e.g. A resume gets scanned for 25 seconds.
- margin** (noun): the space at the left or right side of a page where words are not written
e.g. To begin, use wide margins.
- format** (noun): the appearance of something
e.g. To begin, use a logical format.
- to catch someone's eye** (expression): to get someone's attention
e.g. You need to use bold and italic on areas that you want to catch the reader's eye.
- bullet** (noun): a printed circle before each thing on a list so as to emphasize it
e.g. It is also important to use bullets to emphasize accomplishments.
- to cement** (verb): to make an idea or relationship stronger
e.g. I cemented relationships with customers.
- to empower** (verb): to give someone more power to do something
e.g. I empowered employees through shared decisions.





Learning Points

What Clauses and Long Phrases as Subject

When you use a *what*, *that*, or *who* clause as the subject of a sentence, you have shifted the emphasis away from the words that sit in the subject position.

Look at these examples:

Original Sentence

The layout is the first thing we need to work on.

(the emphasis here is on 'layout' because it's in the subject position)

Noun Clause Sentence

What we need to work on first is the layout.

(the emphasis is now on 'what we need to work on' as it has been moved to the subject position)

So, if you want to place emphasis on the verb, direct object, or another part of the sentence, you use a *what*-phrase (or sometimes a *that*-clause).

For example:

He really wanted to find a new job.

becomes

What he really wanted to find was a new job.

This is how we form "What" clauses.

subject / What-phrase	be	complement
<i>The first thing we need to work on</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>the layout.</i>
<i>What you want to present</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>an organized summary of your qualifications.</i>
<i>What a friend had told me</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>that a résumé gets scanned for 25 seconds.</i>
<i>What you are saying</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>I should identify accomplishments.</i>





Learning Points

Résumés & Action Verbs

When writing a résumé, it is important to show your potential employer all your skills. In order for you to do that, you should use action verbs to help you describe these skills.

A good idea is to start your résumé with bullet points that include action verbs. It will make your descriptions more powerful.

Here are some action verbs you could use:

- *Instead of saying you worked with customers, you could say you "**cemented** relationship with customers"*
- *It says here you "helped employees". You could rewrite this as you "**empowered** employees through shared decisions".*
- *And don't write that you 'dealt with problems' ... say "I **solved** problems without increasing costs."*

More action verbs are listed below:

- created, established, built, diagnosed, boosted, improved.

Remember to use these verbs in the past.

Other important things to consider when writing your résumé are:

- Format: use a chronological order as it allows you to highlight your experience.
- Margins: use wide margins
- Font: Clean type such as Times New Roman or Garamond.
- Headings: Clear and logical
- Other: Use **bold** and *italic* on areas you want to catch the reader's eye.

